

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Dr Saba Faruqui

Address: 58 Burdon Lane Cheam SM2 7BY

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing to express my support for planning application DM2025/01591.

As a long-term Sutton resident who also works locally as a doctor, I approach developments such as this with careful consideration. I understand the importance of protecting residential character, road safety and neighbourly amenity. However, I also believe that sustainable communities require accessible spaces that bring people together in a structured and positive way.

This congregation has been gathering locally for approximately three years. During that time, the activity has taken place with minimal complaints and without any significant safety or parking incidents being brought to wider attention. That period of operation is, in my view, relevant. It suggests that the scale and pattern of use are manageable within the local context.

Some concerns have been raised regarding traffic and parking pressures. While these issues always merit scrutiny, it is important to distinguish between theoretical peak scenarios and lived experience. The existing pattern of gatherings has not resulted in any demonstrable breakdown in road safety or neighbourhood function. Where activity is predictable and time-limited, communities often adapt without long-term harm.

There have also been concerns about residential amenity. In my observation, the gatherings have been orderly and respectful. A permanent, properly managed facility is likely to improve organisation and oversight further, rather than diminish it.

Beyond addressing concerns, I believe the proposal offers tangible benefits. Community centres

provide a focal point for social interaction, youth engagement and informal support networks. In modern urban settings, where isolation is increasingly common, these shared spaces are valuable. From my professional experience, social connection and structured community involvement are protective factors for mental wellbeing and resilience, particularly among young people and older residents.

This proposal does not introduce an entirely new activity to the area. It regularises and formalises an existing one within a more suitable setting. In doing so, it offers the opportunity to strengthen community cohesion while remaining proportionate in scale.

For these reasons, I believe the application represents a balanced and constructive development, and I respectfully request that Sutton Council grants approval.